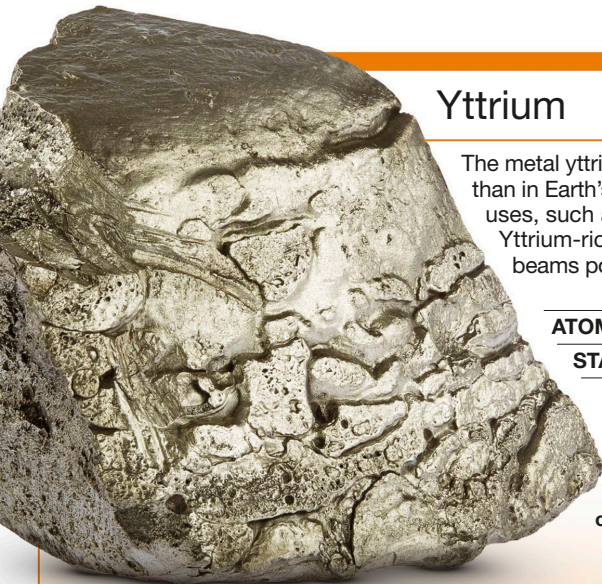




Yttrium

39
Y

The metal yttrium is more common in Moon rocks than in Earth's crust. It has a number of high-tech uses, such as in the making of camera lenses. Yttrium-rich crystals can also make laser beams powerful enough to cut through metal.

ATOMIC MASS 88.906

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1794 (Johan Gadolin)

Laboratory sample
of pure yttrium

Zirconium

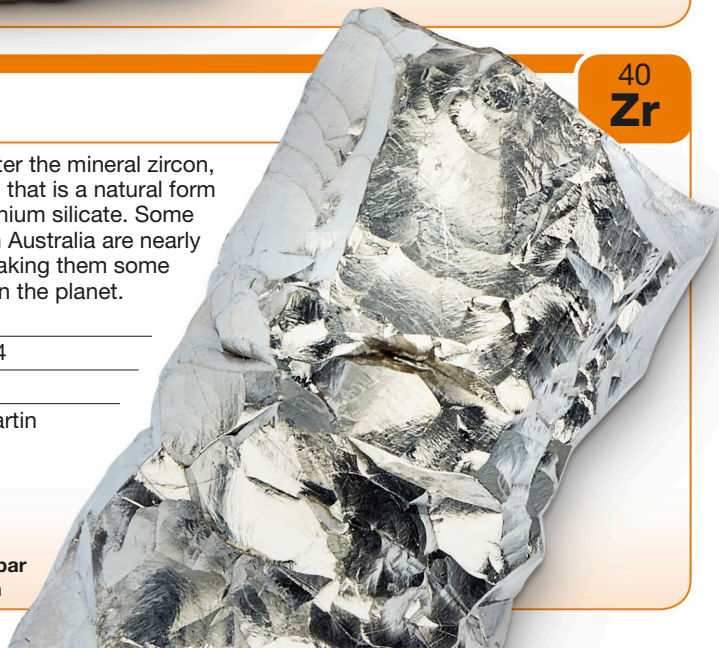
This metal is named after the mineral zircon, a golden-brown crystal that is a natural form of the compound zirconium silicate. Some zircon crystals found in Australia are nearly 4.4 billion years old, making them some of the oldest crystals on the planet.

ATOMIC MASS 91.224

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1789 (Martin Heinrich Klaproth)

Laboratory-refined bar
of pure zirconium



40
Zr